The Day of the Lord and Believers

In contrast to the unbelievers who will face the Day of the Lord, believers are loved, chosen, set apart and appointed to deliverance — so stand fast and hold the apostolic Word.

Where this study fits

2 Thessalonians · seven studies · this study highlighted

01 1:1–2
Introduction and Background

02 1:3–12
Paul's Admiration for the Thessalonians

03 2:1–5
Confusion Concerning the Coming

04 2:6–12
The Removal of the Restrainer

05 2:13–17
The Day of the Lord and Believers

06 3:1–12
Serving While Waiting

07 3:13–18
My Brother's Keeper

Grace and peace frame the letter (1:2; 3:16–18): persecution in chapter 1, prophecy in chapter 2, correction in chapter 3.

Their position — 2:13–14

2 Thessalonians 2:13–14 · I.A–D

Situation · 13a
ἀγαπάω beloved

- Brothers of Paul
- Beloved by the Lord

Selection · 13b
αἱρέομαι chose

- The Father chose
- The Spirit set apart
- They believed the truth

Salvation · 13c
σωτηρία deliverance

- Deliverance — here, from the wrath of the Tribulation

Glorification · 14
περιποίησις obtaining

- Called by “our gospel”
- To share Christ’s glory

“But” (2:13) — they are going to be in it; not you. Verse 12: condemned who did not believe the truth. Verse 13: you believed the truth.

“God … chose you” — which word?

2 Thessalonians 2:13b · I.B.1 — The Father chose

2 Thess 2:13 — haireomai
αἱρέομαι to pick, choose · G138

- Used of picking fruit
- Elsewhere only Phil 1:22; Heb 11:25
- “From the beginning” of the gospel there
- Chosen to escape the Tribulation

vs

Ephesians 1:4 — eklegomai
ἐξελέξατο He chose us · election

- “Before the foundation of the world”
- Choosing to eternal life
- The teacher still holds it firmly
- — but doesn’t see it here

The Father chose, the Holy Spirit conferred (“sanctification by the Spirit”), and the Thessalonians concurred (“belief in the truth”).

Three tenses of sanctification

2 Thessalonians 2:13 · I.B.2 — “through sanctification by the Spirit”

A

Past — a position

Set apart to God the moment we believe

Paul’s main point here

B

Present — a process

Transformed by the Word and the Spirit

John 17:17 · 2 Cor 3:18

C

Future — a prospect

“We shall be like Him”

1 John 3:2

ἁγιασμός sanctification — here mainly the positional setting apart by the Spirit

Paul may have all three in mind — but mainly our past sanctification, which placed us into the body of Christ.

Salvation means deliverance — from what?

2 Thessalonians 2:13c · I.C — Their salvation

A **Spiritual**

From sin's penalty, power and presence

B **Physical**

"They were healed" — delivered from blindness, lameness

C **Circumstances**

Peter sinking: "Lord, save me!" (Matt 14:30)

D **Matthew 24:13**

Enduring through the Tribulation — not keeping eternal life

E **1 Thess 5:9**

"Not appointed to wrath, but to obtain salvation"

✓ **Here · 2:13**

Deliverance from the wrath of the Tribulation

Stand fast and hold the Word

2 Thessalonians 2:15 · II.A — Our responsibility

A

Hear it

No daydreaming

first

B

Check it

Make sure it's the Word of God

"show me"

C

Review it

Get it in your head

D

Believe it

If you believe it, you'll do it

E

Share it

You understand it better when you help someone else

Hold the traditions

παράδοσις G3862

- By word — what Paul taught in person
- By epistle — what he wrote

Apostolicity = canonicity

- When the apostles were gone, the canon was closed
- John 14:26; 16:13

Our resources

2 Thessalonians 2:16–17 · II.B — Their source and content

The source · 16a

- “Our Lord Jesus Christ Himself, and our God and Father”
- “Who” — singular: one God
- According to His riches (Phil 4:19)

God’s love · 16b

παράκλησις · ἐλπίς consolation · hope

- Everlasting consolation
- A good hope, by grace
- No charge

God’s life · 17

στηρίζω establish · G4741

- Comforts your hearts
- Establishes you in every good word and work

Your hope is not in this government or the Constitution. Your hope is in the Lord — a good hope that assures you of the return of your victorious Savior.

Discuss and apply

2 Thessalonians 2:13–17 · from the study's posted questions and applications

Discuss

1. How should we determine the meaning of “salvation,” and what does it mean in 2:13?

2. What five things does the teacher say we must do with the Word so that it does not slip away?

Apply

Read “Saved” in Context
Work through the handout passages this week, asking “saved from what?” for each one.

Five Steps to Holding the Word
Write down one truth, review it daily, and share it with one person before next week.

In one line: Loved, chosen, set apart and appointed to deliverance — so stand fast, hold the Word, and draw on His love, comfort and good hope.